

GRUSH VENTURES — Self-Employment Business Plan (Summary)

Veteran Readiness & Employment (Chapter 31) · Self-Employment Track

Chad Eric Pattengale · Riverside, CA · U.S. Marine Corps (Honorable) · 100% Permanent & Total service-connected · VA Claim #: _____ ·

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1 • Vocational Goal

Self-employment as founder and operator of Grush Ventures, an environmental production-and-restoration company. The anchor business is Fun Guy Fungi, a single-container gourmet mushroom farm. Additional revenue streams (Grush software, modular grow structures, soil-restoration products) develop in sequence, each funded by the one before it.

2 • Founder Qualifications

A career of high-consequence, get-it-right-the-first-time roles: Marine linguist; 911 operator; armed power-plant guard; nurse across cardiac ICU, emergency, trauma, and correctional units; and electrician, builder, and project coordinator on the power-distribution buildings that AI data centers and utilities depend on. Currently completing a B.S. in Environmental Science (California Baptist University). He self-taught and built the Grush software platform end-to-end (two live deployments). This breadth — field operations, healthcare, the trades, and applied environmental science — directly equips the production, systems, and restoration sides of the venture.

3 • Why Self-Employment Is the Feasible Path

The veteran's service-connected disabilities are rated 100% Permanent & Total. The inflammatory nature of his physical conditions requires the ability to self-manage his work pace and to modify or pause his schedule to recover during flares; his service-connected chronic PTSD requires flexibility to alter his daily routine as symptoms dictate. Traditional employment — a fixed schedule, a set worksite, and an employer-controlled pace — cannot reliably accommodate these needs. Self-employment lets the work be structured around his medical reality. The container-farm model reinforces this fit: indoor, climate-controlled, single-operator, and task-flexible, so daily tasks can shift by hours.

6 • Financial Summary (conservative baseline — to be localized with VBOC)

Metric	Conservative estimate
Steady-state output	~300 lb/week (40-ft container ceiling ~400 lb)
Blended price	~\$10/lb wholesale-weighted (direct \$15-18/lb = upside)
Weekly revenue	~\$3,000
Production cost	~\$5/lb (top of \$2.50-5.50 range)
Weekly net over production	~\$1,500
Annual revenue (48 wks)	~\$144,000
Annual net over production	~\$72,000
Year 1 (ramp)	~\$30,000-40,000; steady sales 3-6 mo post-buildout

Operating costs (HVAC/electricity, packaging) run ~35-50% of revenue; facility lease is a separate, location-dependent line (TBD). The veteran's VA compensation covers personal living expenses independent of the business, so early revenue can be reinvested in growth. *Figures are industry-baseline projections to be verified and localized with the LA VBOC.*

7 • VR&E Request

- Startup funding for the Fun Guy Fungi buildout — equipment, tools, supplies, and initial inventory (container fit-out, sterilization/lab gear, climate control, shelving, spawn/substrate). Scoped and staged under the \$25,000 local-approval threshold, pre-approved before purchase.
- Completion of the B.S. in Environmental Science, required for the restoration/remediation lines that need credentialed environmental expertise. Hiring that expertise is legally blocked (an F-1 visa) or economically unviable for a startup (recurring six-figure cost); building it into the founder is the one-time, lower-cost path.

4 • Business & Revenue Streams

- Phase 1 — Fun Guy Fungi (launch): high-value gourmet mushroom production in a 40-ft container; the first revenue engine and the live proof-of-concept for the Grush platform.
- Phase 2 — Grush software: a field-management platform (already built, running Fun Guy Fungi and a second site) licensed to growers of every scale, with Fun Guy Fungi as its showcase.
- Roadmap (self-funded, not part of this request): a modular grow-structure product line (GC-DPS, patent-pending) and a soil-restoration products line applying environmental-science R&D.

5 • Market

Gourmet and functional mushrooms have sustained, growing demand and are classified as fresh produce (minimal permitting). Channels: direct-to-restaurant, farmers markets, specialty grocers/CSA, and value-added products (dried, extracts). Industry data (2025-26) puts wholesale at ~\$7-14/lb and restaurant/market direct at ~\$16-24/lb; the decisive profit driver is channel mix, not raw yield. Strategy: standing restaurant accounts for baseline cash flow, direct/market channels for margin, and warm/cool species rotation to manage Riverside HVAC cost.

8 • Roadmap Note

Not part of this request. Property acquisition and on-site agricultural caretaker housing are planned as a Phase-2 growth move, financed from business strength (e.g., SBA / veteran lending) once the operation is proven — not required to launch.

Sources: Northstar Financial (2026 mushroom economics), Fungi Ally, container-farm & USDA/SBA market data. VBOC coordination per 38 CFR §21.257(d) in progress; full business plan to be finalized with the LA VBOC.